



Retail in Colombia: A Growing and Resilient Market

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FENALCO
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Who we are?

National Trade Federation **FENALCO**

The Force That
Brings Business
Together

FENALCO at a Glance



93%

of members are
MiPyme
(MSMEs)

81 years

18

Thousand
members
across
different
sectors

320 thousand

Affiliated
neighborhood stores

28 National
sectors

54 SubSectors

We are a retail association that represents the interests of the country's organized commerce and, more broadly, the Colombian business community. As a proactive association, we work to safeguard the health of the economy and the country's democratic stability, upholding the values of the Constitution, free enterprise, and competition.

120

Different business
activities

Presence in
25 Cities across
Colombia
through
regional
offices

+34

years

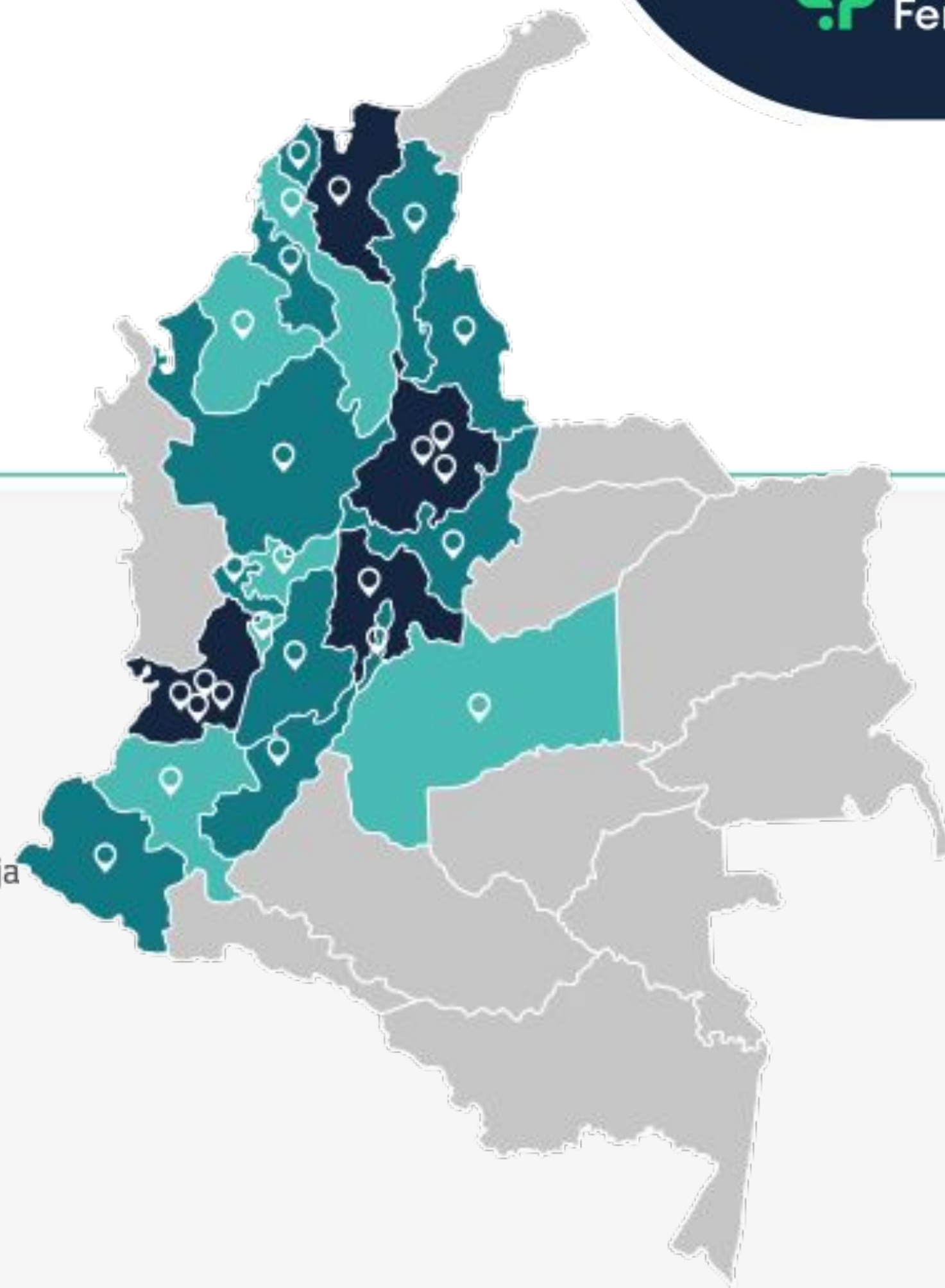
Of experience in
project
implementation

FENALCO is the largest and most democratic trade association, with a general and cross-sectoral scope that spans all sectors of the economy.

Fenalco maintains a strong nationwide presence, with operations across 25 cities.

- Fenalco Antioquia
- Fenalco Atlántico
- Fenalco Bolívar
- Fenalco Bogotá
- Fenalco Caldas
- Fenalco Cesar
- Fenalco Córdoba
- Fenalco Huila
- Fenalco Meta
- Fenalco Nariño
- Fenalco Norte de Santander
- Fenalco Quindío
- Fenalco Risaralda

- Fenalco Santa Marta
- Fenalco Santander
- Fenalco Sucre
- Fenalco Tolima
- Fenalco Valle del Cauca
- Fenalco Capitulo Barrancabermeja
- Fenalco Capitulo Cartago
- Fenalco Capitulo Palmira
- Fenalco Capitulo Popayán
- Fenalco Capitulo San Gil
- Fenalco Capitulo Tuluá
- Fenalco Capitulo Boyacá





Fenaltiendas



Healthcare



Large Retail Chains



Grocery Retail



Mattresses



Automotive



Textiles and Apparel



Technology



Home Goods



Restaurants



Footwear and Leather



Jewelry

+28



Foreign Trade



Education

**Economic sectors
represented by FENALCO**



Construction



Real Estate



**Public Entertainment – Cultural
and Creative Economy**



Beauty



Private Security



Tourism



Technology Platforms



Shopping Centers



Light Mobility



Funeral Services



Tires



Agricultural Inputs



Heavy Machinery



Veterinary Services

+ 28

**Economic sectors
represented by FENALCO**

Commerce as a driver of growth and national development



2'005.613

Total Companies



1'258.998

Retail businesses



55,15%

All companies are
engaged in retail
trade.

**Colombia: A
Nation Built on
Commerce**

Distribution of Microenterprises by Economic Sector (2025)

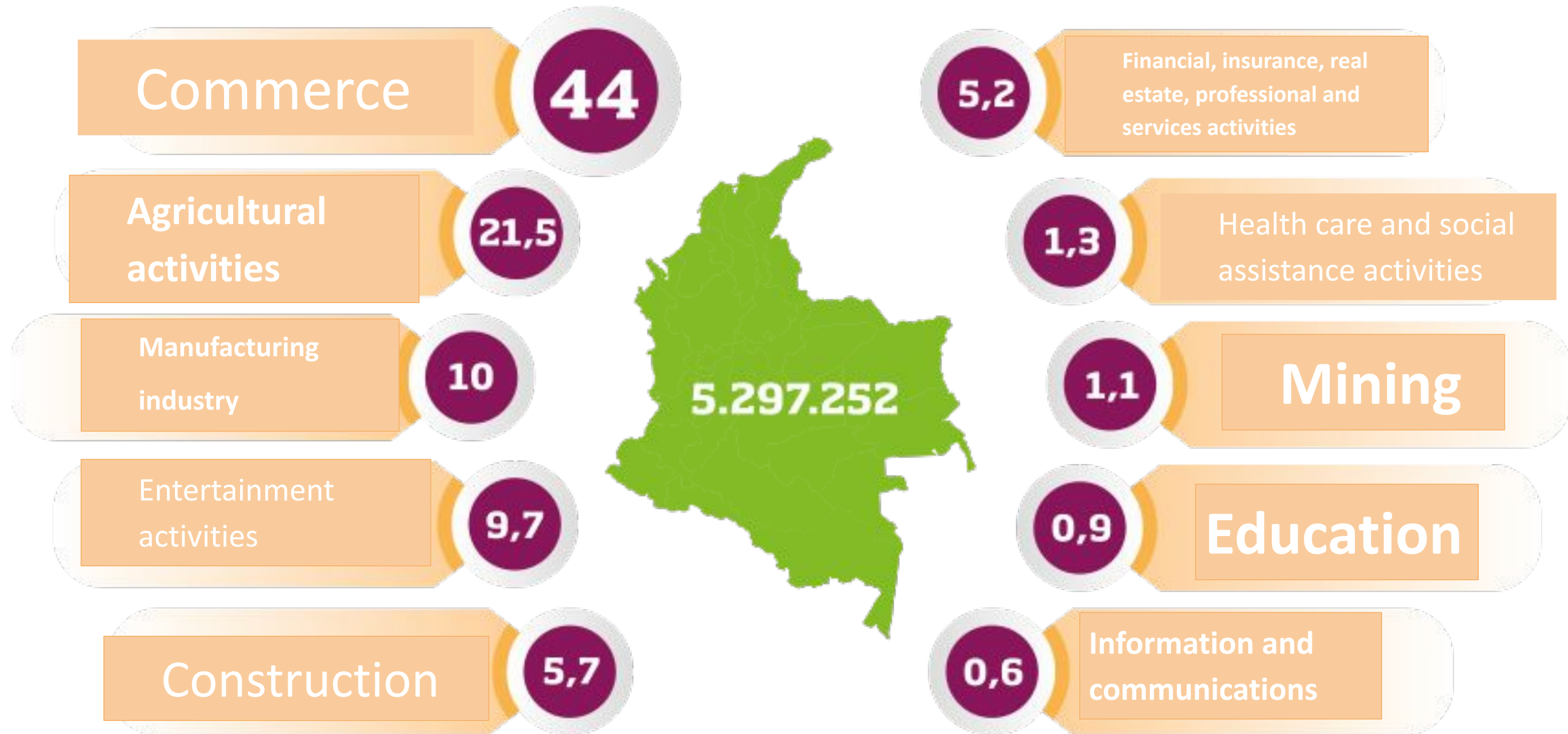
Trade and Its Contribution to National GDP (2025)

***23.1% of GDP**

Includes wholesale and **retail trade**; repair of motor vehicles and motorcycles; transportation and storage; accommodation; and food and entertainment services.



business distribution according to economy activity(2024)

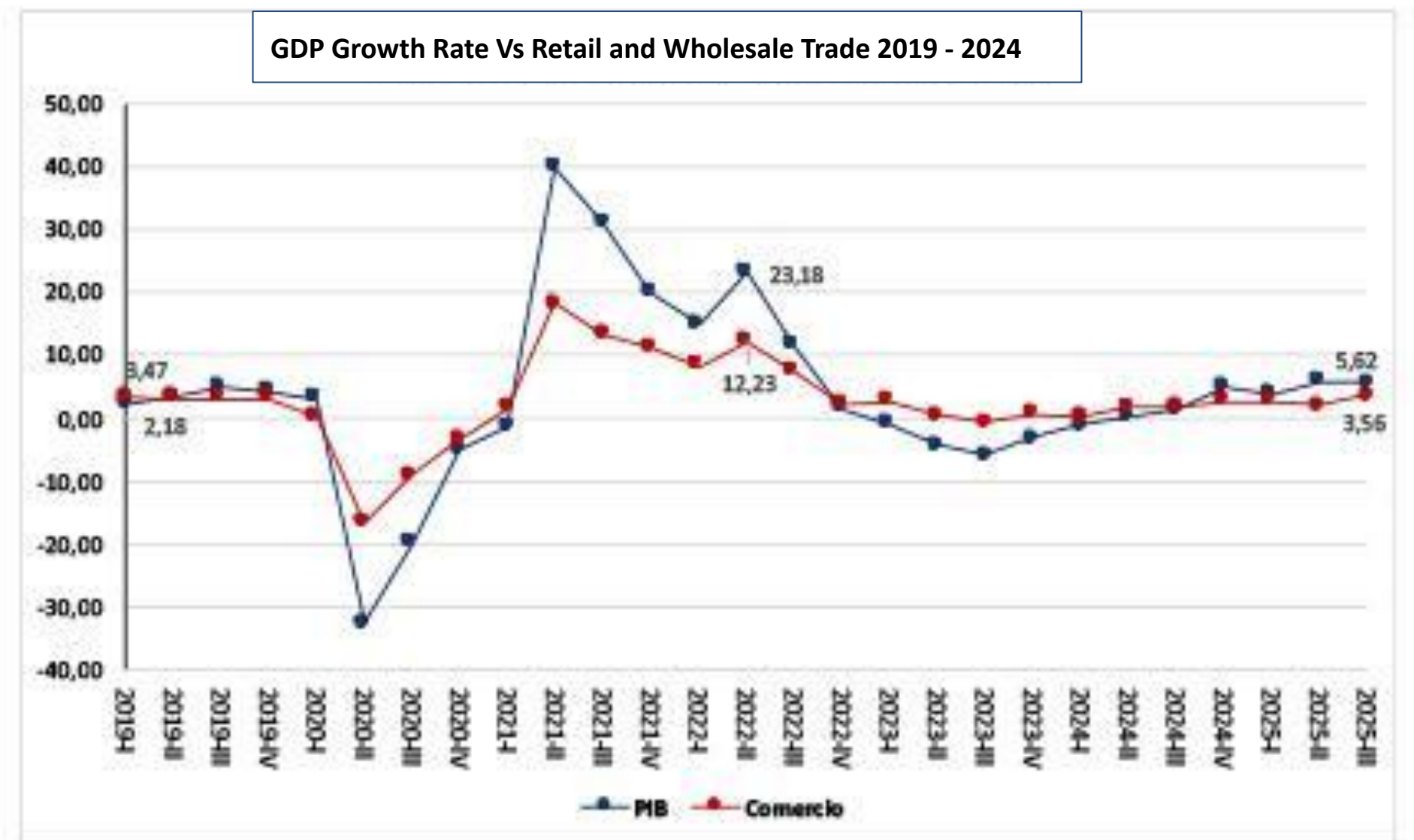


Source: DANE - EMICRON, 2024

*Includes commerce and repair of motor vehicles and motorcycles, transportation and storage, accommodation and food services.

Commerce is the key driver of the colombian economy

Beyond its substantial contribution to wealth creation, the retail sector emerges as the foremost source of employment across the country.



Trade generates **32.6% of total**
employment **7.891.000 Jobs**

When the entertainment sector is
considered, total job increases to **41.3%**
10.011.00 Jobs

Source: DANE, 2025



41% of youth employment
is generated by the **retail,**
tourism, transportation
and entertainment
cluster.



These sectors enable young
colombians to achieve their
economic and personal
aspirations.

Women represent 41.9%

of employment in the commerce sector.



24.298.000

Were employed in
Colombia from September
to November 2025.



Of These
10.170.000
were women, representing
41.9%.

Retail Performance – Key Figures

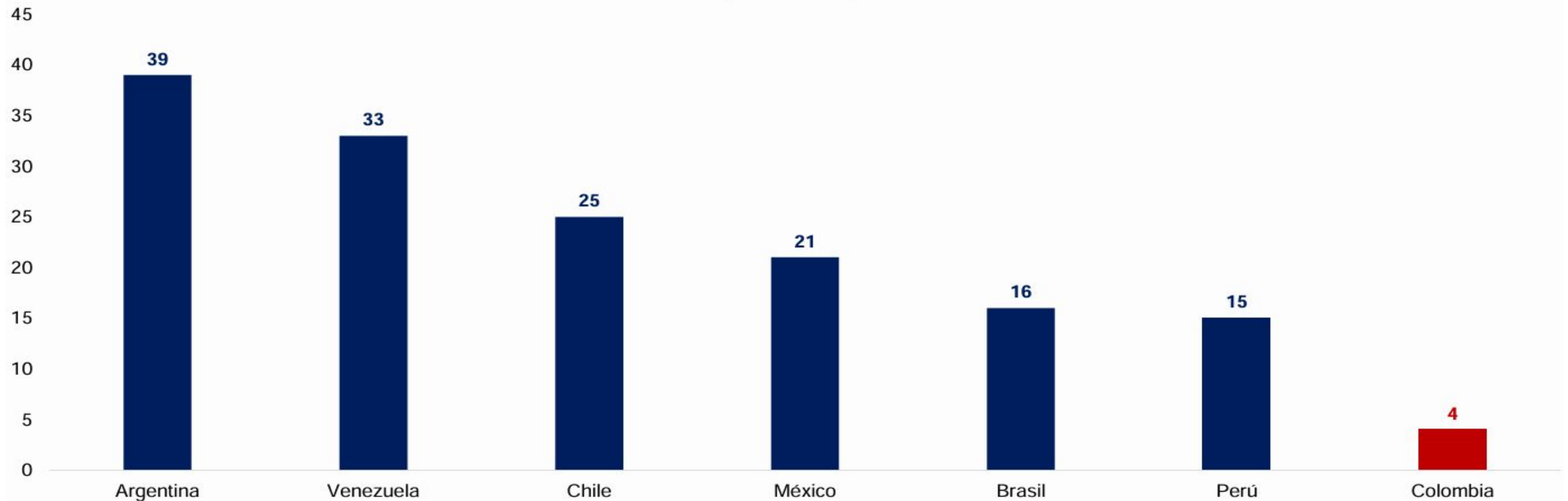


- Colombia's economy grew by 2.6% in 2025, outperforming Brazil (2.3%), Chile (2.1%), and Mexico (1.2%). The World Bank projects 2.7% growth for 2026, a positive outlook, though still insufficient to meet the country's needs.
- The main concern is not growth itself, but its composition. Economic expansion is currently driven mainly by household consumption and public spending, while capital investment remains weak. Gross capital formation grew only 2.1%, and its share of GDP declined to 16%, down from around 24% a decade ago.
- In the retail sector, formal retail sales increased by 11.7% in 2025, driven primarily by durable goods. However, categories such as food (3.6%) and non-alcoholic beverages (2.8%) grew at a slower pace, and early 2026 data point to a deceleration.

Over the past 124 years, Colombia has experienced negative economic growth on only four occasions: in 1930 and 1931 (the Great Depression), in 1999 (the Russian crisis and the emerging markets crisis),

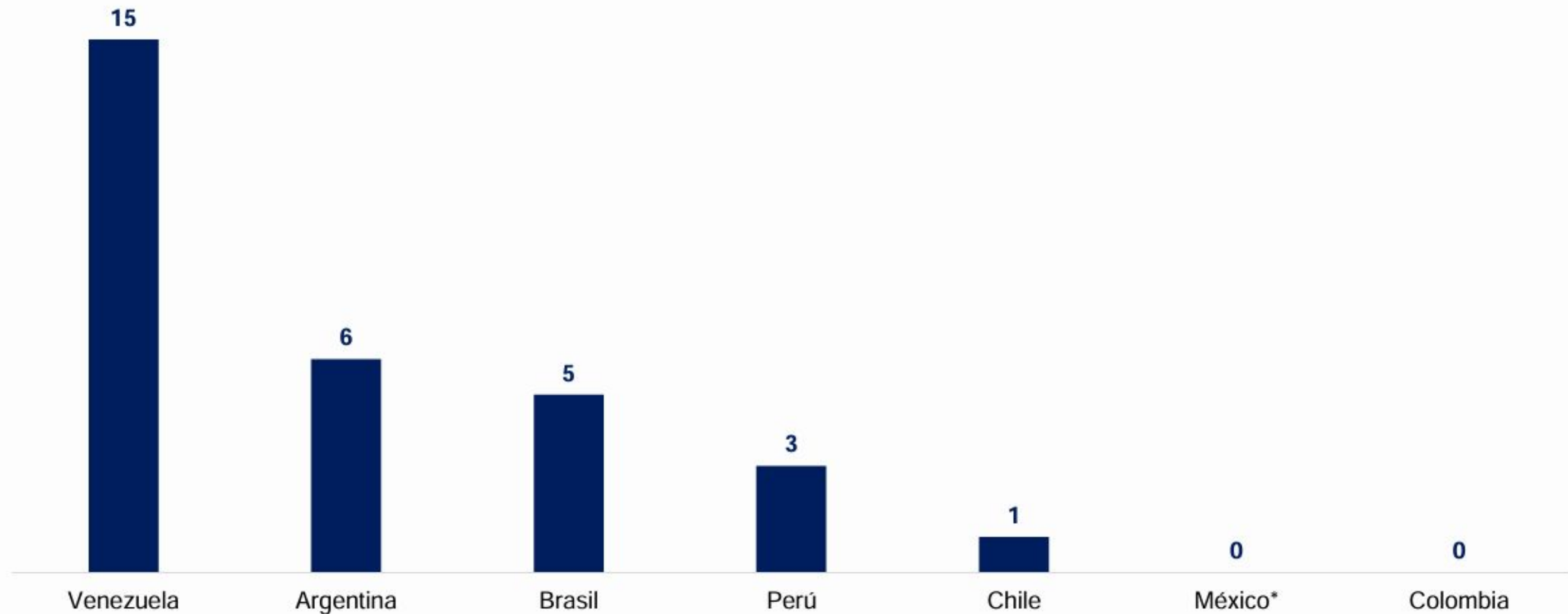
Years of negative growth in the main Latin American economies.

(1901 - 2024)



Colombia is among the few countries in the region that have not experienced a hyperinflation episode.

Hyperinflation Episodes in Major Latin American Economies
(Months, 1970-2023)

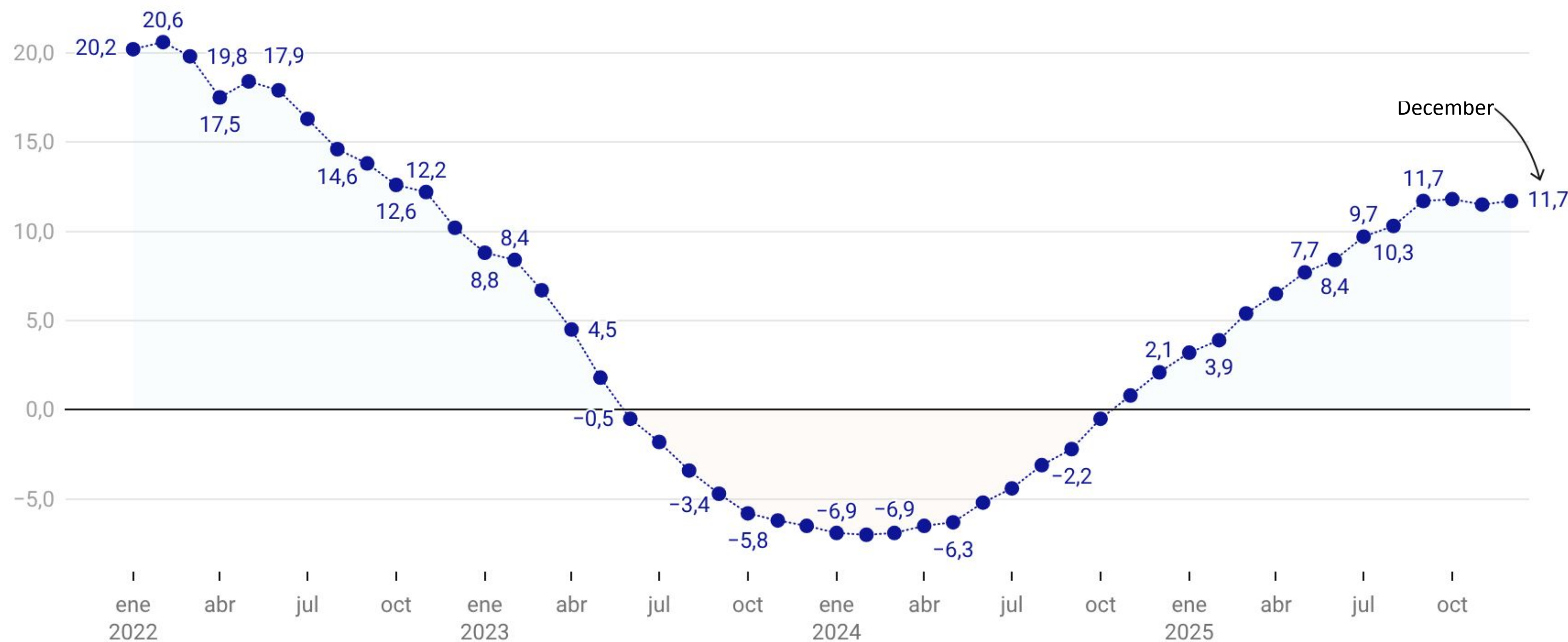


*Aunque México no ha experimentado variaciones mensuales superiores al 50%, entre 1988 y 1989, alcanzó variaciones anuales superiores al 100%.

Data suggest that the retail is entering a phase of recovery



12-Month Percentage Change in Real Retail Sales Volume (2022–2025)



Top 5 – % Change in Real Sales (December 2025)



Best Performance

Product Category		
1	IT and telecommunications equipment	49,3
2	Sound and video equipment	25,5
3	Vehicles and motorcycles	24,9
4	Home appliances and furniture	20,9
5.	Household goods and utensils	12,6
5.	Household goods and utensils	12,6



Worst Performance

Product Category		
1	Fuels	1,4
2	Non-alcoholic beverages	2,8
3	Food	3,6
4	Clothing and textiles	4,8
5.	Books, stationery, newspapers and magazines	5,4
5.	Total retail sector	5,4

Total retail sector | **11,7%**



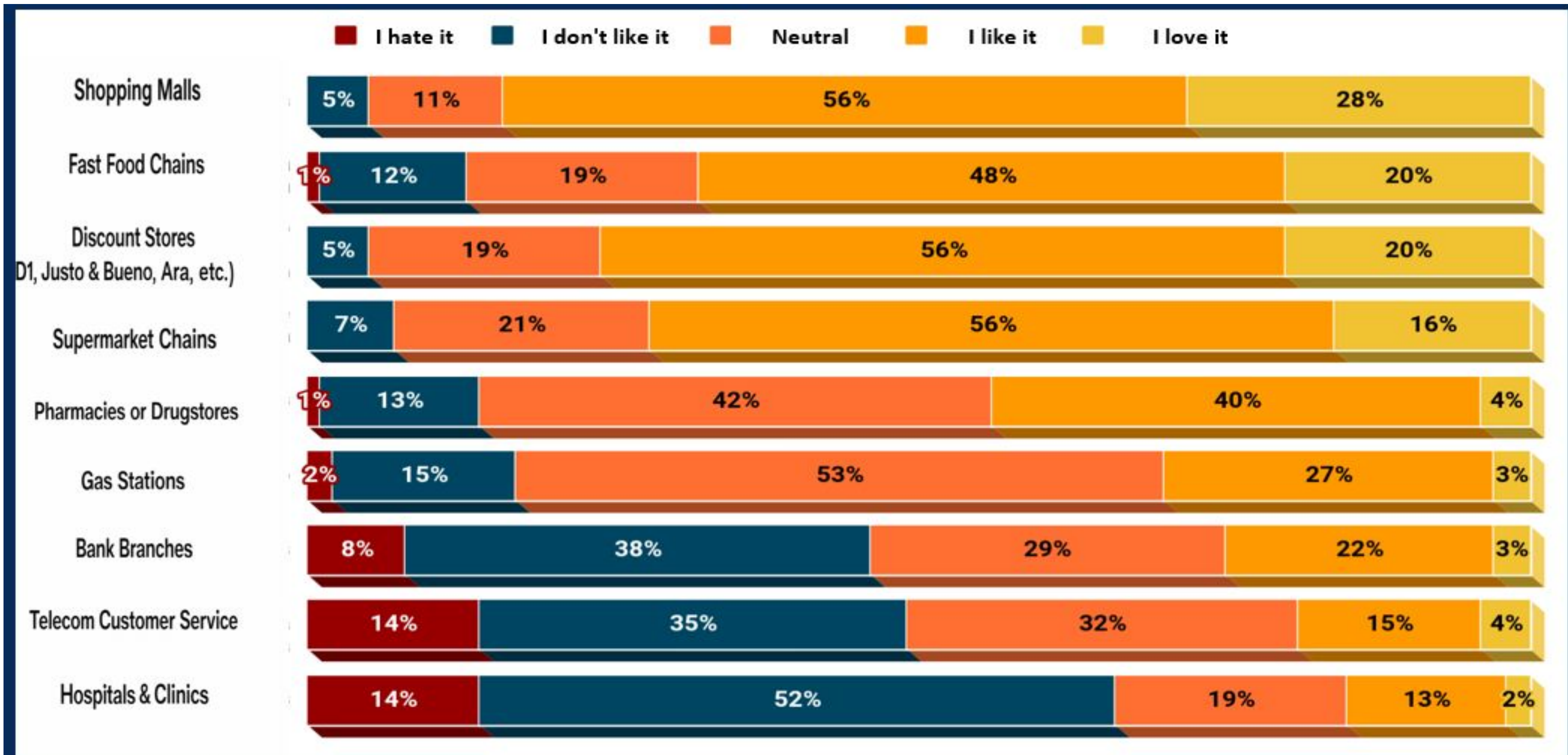
Consumer Trends identified by Fenalco

1. High growth in “pets Retail”.
2. A demographic revolution.
3. Household goods and home equipments.
4. Growing demand for entertainment
5. Health and Sports.
6. Beauty and the Cosmetics Industry.
7. Digital Nomads and Foreign Residents

Colombian customer experience by channels



Colombian customer Experience by Channel Fenalco





Key Conclusions

With over 50 million inhabitants, Colombia emerges as a dynamic, high-growth market, where the retail sector presents substantial opportunities for future expansion and investment.

- Commerce is a core pillar of the economy, contributing 23.1% of GDP, while retail alone represents over half of all businesses nationwide (55.15%).
- Beyond its economic weight, the sector is the country's primary engine of employment, generating 32.6% of total jobs rising to 41.3% when including the broader entertainment cluster and serving as a key platform for inclusion, with 41% of youth employment and nearly half of its workforce composed of women (47.2%).
- This strength is reinforced by Colombia's long-term macroeconomic resilience marked by exceptional stability over more than a century and by profound demographic shifts, including smaller household sizes, which are reshaping consumption patterns and creating new opportunities for retail expansion.

Together, these factors position Colombia as one of the most attractive and forward-looking retail markets in Latin America.



Thanks!

Welcome to Colombia

JAIME ALBERTO CABAL S.

FENALCO'S PRESIDENT

March 2026

